

sionals. At that point, RNT was heading Tata Industries. It had not been a remarkable career—before Tata Industries he had helmed NELCO, which manufactured electronics—but he was J.R.D.'s preferred choice.

When RNT entered the corner office at Bombay House in March 1991, he could not have known that gaining acceptance within the group would be difficult. He had to weather many a storm, from a showdown with unions to bringing powerful 'satraps'—who headed some group firms—to heel. He also consolidated his hold over the group, which operated like disparate companies glued together only by the personal charisma of J.R.D. Tata.

After those initial travails, he set about stamping his imprint on the storied conglomerate, making it a force to reckon with in sectors like auto and IT services and has now ventured into sunrise sectors like electric vehicles and semiconductors, and returned to civil aviation.

RNT, who passed away on October 9, leaves behind a conglomerate that had revenues of \$165 billion in FY24 and has a decidedly global outlook.

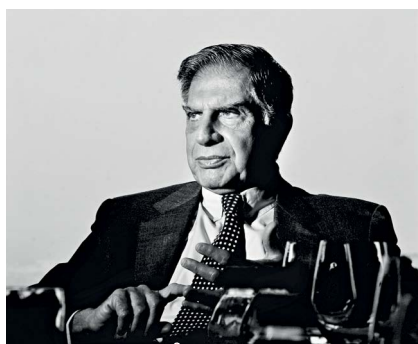
REINING IN THE SATRAPS

In 1991, it looked like RNT had walked right into a storm. The old satraps—most prominently, Russi



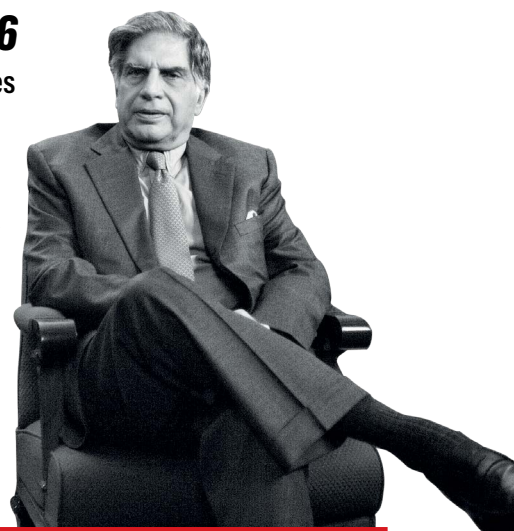
Oct 2012

Tata group revenue hits \$100 billion



Oct 2016

Briefly takes charge as Tata Sons' Chairman after Cyrus Mistry's ouster



LINE



2008

Tata Motors acquires Jaguar Land Rover for \$2.3 billion; launches Tata Nano

Dec 28, 2012

Steps down as Tata Sons' Chairman; Cyrus Mistry steps in



Jan 2022

Tata group acquires Air India from the Government of India